

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1403

By Hicks G

A RESOLUTION to honor William Lewis Jenkins on his receipt of the Hawkins County Republican Party Lifetime Achievement Award.

WHEREAS, William Lewis Jenkins, born on November 29, 1936, has devoted a lifetime of service to the State of Tennessee and the United States of America, exemplifying integrity, leadership, and dedication to public service; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Jenkins is a proud seventh-generation Tennessean with deep roots in Rogersville and Hawkins County, reflecting a lifelong commitment to his community and its values; and

WHEREAS, he honorably served in the United States Army, demonstrating his dedication to the defense and security of our nation; and

WHEREAS, he pursued higher education at Tennessee Technological University and the University of Tennessee College of Law, preparing himself for a distinguished career in law, public service, and leadership; and

WHEREAS, his public service began in the Tennessee General Assembly as a member of the House of Representatives, where he served from 1962 to 1971, and rose to the esteemed position of Speaker of the House, earning the respect of his colleagues and constituents alike; and

WHEREAS, he continued his service as a member of the Board of Directors of the Tennessee Valley Authority and later as a circuit court judge, upholding the rule of law with fairness and integrity; and

WHEREAS, following the retirement of Congressman Jimmy Quillen, Mr. Jenkins answered the call to serve in the United States House of Representatives, representing Tennessee's First Congressional District from 1997 to 2007; and

WHEREAS, during his five terms in Congress, he maintained a steadfast commitment to conservative principles and represented his constituents with dedication, humility, and effectiveness; and

WHEREAS, his distinguished career followed in the legacy of respected leaders such as B. Carroll Reece, contributing to a long tradition of principled representation in Northeast Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, upon announcing his retirement in 2006, Mr. Jenkins demonstrated his enduring commitment to family values, choosing to dedicate more time to his loved ones after decades of public service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate William Lewis Jenkins upon his receipt of the Lifetime Achievement Award from the Hawkins County Republican Party in recognition of his exemplary service, unwavering leadership, and lasting contributions to Hawkins County, the State of Tennessee, and the United States of America.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.